

INDIA PICTURE

Sikkim

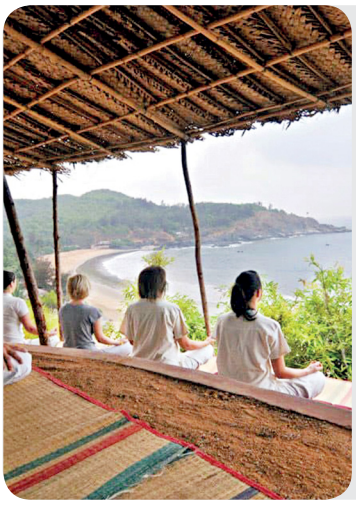
The Lepchas have for a long time taught about the salubrious powers of the hot springs of the region, but these revitalising spots have remained hidden to the outside world. Locally referred to as *tatopani* (hot spring/s), many of these can be visited in North Sikkim (LhabaTarum near Lachen; Reshi near Gyalshina) and elsewhere (Ralong, Borong and Gangyap). From skin detoxification and improved blood circulation to stress reduction, the benefits of a dip in a hot spring are many.



SHUTTERSTOCK

Goa

As a healing destination, Goa is to India what Bali is to the rest of Asia. And so, the tiny seaside state needs no introduction as a wellness hub. It has the best of yoga and sound healing centres. A number of places teach ashtanga yoga and hatha yoga and alternative therapies conducted include chakra healing. There are also conscious living retreats where visitors can undertake detox and holistic wellness programmes.



Karnataka

Three hours south of Goa, a seaside town on the Konkan coast might just give you your next favourite yoga retreat. Spread over 26 acres of forest close to Om Beach, SwaSwara has hatha yoga and pranayama, dosha identification, panchakarma-cleansing and targeted therapies such as snehanam and swedanam. Near Kudle Beach, the Gokarna Yoga School operates from November to March, offering Iyengar Yoga classes for posture and breathing improvement.

MANDAR DEODHAR

Maharashtra

Small towns nestled in scenic natural environs are fast seeing a spurt in relaxing getaway spots. Atmantan near Pune, a luxury wellness resort boasting panchakarma and restorative physiotherapy, overlooks the Mulshi lake. In Vadgaon, Fazlani Nature's Nest, a resort offers equine therapy (a unique technique that engages horses in healing), Ayurveda and naturopathy.



Punjab

For many, getting away from city life and settling down for a few days in bucolic surrounds is food for both body and soul. The northern Indian farmstay experience in India's breadbasket ticks most boxes. Citrus County in Hoshiarpur, Prakriti Farms in Rupnagar and The Kothi in Gurdaspur—the state has no dearth of comfortable stays with a rustic touch, where you can partake of nutritious meals and a virtually endless supply of fresh fruits, go on nature walks and free your arms in the sprawling golden mustard fields.

Meghalaya

The use of traditional herbs in the Khasi healing system is the subject of a proposed wellness tourism project, and has even led to the setting up of the Mebaai Tribal Health and Wellness Centre in Shillong. To be able to truly absorb the Great Outdoors and experience the way locals bond with and heal from nature, go on a hike—the Living Root Bridge Trail and the David Scott Trail are two of the most famous ones in the state.



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-with Prannay Pathak